

A God-Fearing Virus!

An absolutely crazy Trojan now spreading over P2P deletes smut! Eraser-A scours the "share" folder the P2P application is using—for AVI, MPEG, WMV, GIF, and other potentially dirty files. It then erases the porn, warez, and music in those folders! Now *that's* a virus parents would approve of!



Too Much Of A Good Thing

There's a trend on in the US of banning laptops in class. In the news now is Paul Engelking of the University of Oregon, who found his students *gambling online* while they were supposed to be diligently working on an assignment!



Escape

IF ELEPHANT DUNG CAN BE...

Pixel Paintings

The week-long E3—the world's largest video game convention—happened in May this year at the Los Angeles Convention Center. It wasn't just games being played: there was an art exhibit called *Into the Pixel*, now in its third year, which showcased video game art—and which made people ask the question, "Are video games art?"

Into the Pixel was an exhibit that showcased 16 works of video game art chosen from amongst 150 submissions worldwide. The

panel of judges included people from the interactive, fine art and contemporary art worlds.

"Call it life influencing art, or games influencing art, or games influencing life, or art influencing games. Or better yet, why not just call it art?" said Salatino, a former curator of graphic arts at the Getty Research Institute in L.A.

So, well, are video games art? In what many consider the definitive essay on the topic, Henry Jenkins, head of the comparative media



studies program at MIT, wrote that games are indeed art. He titled his essay *Games, the New Lively Art*, in reference to Gilbert Seldes' 1924 book *The Seven Lively Arts*, which lists jazz, films, musicals and comic strips, amongst others, as some of America's greatest contributions to art. (Umm... comic strips are art?)

It's an idle question, really, and the best response probably came from Louis Marchesano, one of the jurors of *Into the Pixel* and an art historian whose expertise is 17th- and 18th-century art. "Are video games art? I'm not going to answer that



Whatever Happened To...

The AMD PIC

In 2004, AMD debuted the Personal Internet Communicator—the PIC. The idea was to create a simple, affordable solution for the masses, which had all the necessary goodies to connect to the Internet. It would sell in developing nations such as India, Brazil, Mexico, and others of the league. Sound familiar? Like so many other devices that promised to bring computing to the masses, the PIC seems to have taken the long walk into oblivion. And with so much going for it, too. It runs on a 333-400MHz AMD Geode GX processor, has 128 MB of RAM, a 10 GB hard disk, a LAN interface and four USB ports. Connect a keyboard, monitor, mouse and a modem or LAN connection to it, and the Web is yours! Of course, you have to get past what a silly device this is first. For one thing, it runs Windows CE—whatever heard of licensed software on an affordable device? Still, the claim is that Windows CE is only \$3 out of its not entirely affordable price of \$249 (just over Rs 10,000, including a keyboard, mouse and CRT monitor). Then there's the fact that you can't install new software. The BIOS prevents you from installing Linux, too! And the final push—visit AMD's site to look up where you can buy this product in India, and surprise, surprise: for a product launched for nations like India, this one isn't even available on the site!

Win!

My Desktop

This month's winner is Tarun Brari. Please mail us your address, Tarun!

How he did it:

Object bar 1.2
Yahoo widget engine
iTunes remote widget, weather widget, calendar and digital clock
Any suitable Macintosh wallpaper

Participate in this contest and win

Introducing Maya 7 3D for Beginners

by Dariush Derakhshani

Published by

WILEY-INDIA



Send your desktop with description of how you made it to mydesktop@thinkdigit.com with the subject "My Desktop", and tell us your postal address, too.